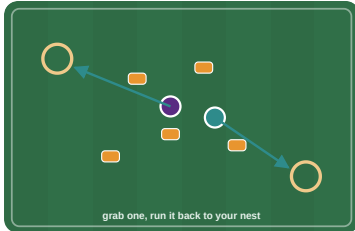




FIRST TOUCH AND RECEIVING

Controlling the ball

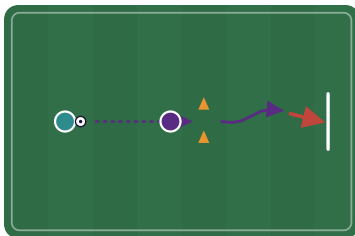
SESSION PLAN



WARM-UP · OPTIONAL Fill the nest 10 min

Scatter pinnies or cones across the grid and give each team a hoop or cone as their 'nest'. On 'go', players run out, grab one item at a time, and bring it home. Most items wins. To add the ball, have them trap a gently rolled ball and dribble it back.

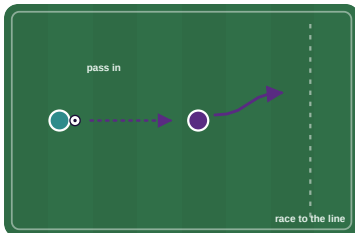
SAY IT SIMPLY "One at a time!" · "Run it home!" · "Soft hands!"



PLAY Receive and Score 15 min

Play this first, no coaching yet. A server passes to a player waiting at a cone gate. The player controls the ball, dribbles through the gate, and finishes at a goal a few yards beyond it. Rotate the server regularly.

SAY IT SIMPLY "Control it first!" · "Then go to goal!" · "Stay calm!"



PRACTICE Trap and race 15 min

Now teach it: this fixes what just came up in Play. A server rolls the ball in. The receiver traps it with a good first touch, then races it out to a line before the coach counts to three. Swap roles every few turns.

SAY IT SIMPLY "Trap it!" · "Touch and run!" · "Beat the count!"

PLAY Small-sided play 15 to 20 min

Bring the game back so it gets used. Even teams, 3v3 or 4v4 to small goals. Light coaching, let them play.

SAY IT SIMPLY "Good first touch!"

WHY IT MATTERS

First touch decides whether a player can keep playing or has to chase a poor control. It comes after passing on purpose. Players now have a reason to control the ball, so they can set up the next pass or dribble.

HOW IT DEVELOPS

- | | |
|------------------|--|
| U7 to U8 | Take the first touch into space, away from where a defender would be. |
| U8 to U10 | First touch into space under pressure. Controlling different speeds and heights. Setting up to play forward. |